

Endocrine Physical Exam

NOT to be performed in any particular order but based on history and differential

HEENT

- Hair (brittle - hypothyroid, hair loss - hyper/hypothyroid etc.)
- Eyebrows (lateral 3rd missing - hypothyroid)
- Eyes (exophthalmos, lid lag – hyperthyroidism)
- Face (moon facies - indicates high cortisol)
- Mandible (protruded or prognathism - acromegaly)
- Tongue (macroglossia - Acromegaly)

Neck

- Thyroid (observe for goiter, nodules; palpate for nodules, tenderness, asymmetry in elevation)
- Posterior neck (posterior supraclavicular fat pad - indicates high cortisol, acanthosis nigricans - diabetes)

Hands

- Fine tremors (hyperthyroidism)
- Soft tissue (dry skin - hypothyroid, diaphoretic - hyperthyroid, palmar hyperpigmentation - Addison's/Cushing's disease)
- Radial pulse (Tachycardia - hyperthyroid, bradycardia - hypothyroidism)

Abdomen

- Violaceous Striae (increased cortisol, increased weight rapidly)

Lower extremities

- Non-pitting edema (Pretibial myxedema - Grave's disease)

Neuro

- DTRS (hyperreflexia - hyperthyroid, hyporeflexia - hypothyroid)
- Proximal muscle weakness (Cushing's, hypercortisolism, hypo/hyperthyroidism, hypercalcemia)

Special Tests



Lid lag
Positive indicative of hyperthyroidism



Chvostek's sign
Positive indicative of hypocalcemia



Trousseau's sign
Positive indicative of hypocalcemia